

Corrected Lineage of Revolutionary Soldiers Asa and Jesse Hall of Montgomery County, Virginia

*Reconstructing the Historical and Genetic Reality of an Early Montgomery County
Family*

2026 Revision and Corroboration of the 2000 Hall Lineage Study

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Version 1.0

Foreword: From the 2000 Compilation to the 2026 Revision

In 2000 I compiled *A Slice of History: A Story of a Hall Family of America* as a record of the Hall family of Montgomery County, Virginia. The volume gathered old family papers, correspondence, and published genealogical material into one place so that the next generation would have something concrete to work with. Among the documents it preserved was a 1970 lineage record prepared by the Daughters of the American Revolution, *The Hall Family History Montgomery County, Virginia 1605–1922*. At the time, that record offered the most detailed narrative available: it traced the Montgomery County Halls back to an aristocratic Wallingford, Connecticut line and gave the family a tidy, distinguished origin.

The 2000 compilation reproduced that record faithfully. It was not meant to be the final word; it was meant to preserve the documents then in circulation. Yet because the DAR record carried an institutional stamp, its Connecticut hypothesis was repeated in county histories, online trees, and my own pages long after its weaknesses should have been apparent. The record did not rest on continuous, locality-by-locality evidence. It rested on names that looked alike in different states, a method that can invent connections as easily as it finds them.

A quarter-century later, new evidence has made a very different story unavoidable. Direct male-line Y-DNA testing places the Hall paternal line in **haplogroup G-M201**, specifically the G2a subgroup. The Connecticut Hall families that the 1970 record proposed as ancestors belong consistently to **haplogroup R-M269**. These two signatures diverged many thousands of years ago; they cannot represent a recent paternal ancestor. My own test, and the results of matching Hall descendants in the FamilyTreeDNA Hall surname project, confirm the same G-M201 signature. The Connecticut hypothesis is therefore genetically impossible.

Equally important, the independent research of **Wanda Ware DeGidio** has reconstructed a continuous Rhode Island–to–New York Hall line that leads to Montgomery County, Virginia, without passing through Connecticut. Virginia land patents and the 1841 probate inventory anchor Asa Hall's life firmly in the Roanoke Valley. The result is a documented, evidence-based account rather than an inherited story.

This 2026 revision deliberately keeps *A Slice of History* in the record as a source of original documents, including the 1970 DAR record, but it rejects the Connecticut speculations that record advanced. The monograph that follows restores the Hall family to its actual historical setting: Revolutionary War service in New York regiments, migration to the Virginia frontier, and a life built on land, livestock, and literacy in the Roanoke Valley.

Abstract

For decades, genealogical records incorrectly linked the pioneer Asa Hall of Montgomery County, Virginia, to an aristocratic Connecticut lineage. This 2026 revision demonstrates that the decisive evidence comes from Y-DNA haplogroup **G-M201** (defined by the M201 mutation), which directly refutes the Connecticut hypothesis and points instead to the Rhode Island-to-New York Hall line documented by Wanda Ware DeGidio. The report is organized as follows:

1. **Definitive Y-DNA proof** — the G-M201 haplogroup and why it rules out a recent Connecticut paternal ancestor.
2. **My Y-DNA result** — how my own direct male-line test places me in the G-M201 Hall group.
3. **FamilyTreeDNA project evidence** — how the Hall surname project confirms the same paternal signature.
4. **The 1970 DAR record and its spread** — how a flawed 1970 lineage record, *The Hall Family History Montgomery County, Virginia 1605–1922*, was amplified through genealogical institutions and later preserved in my 2000 compilation.
5. **The real genealogical record** — the land, probate, and lineage evidence that establishes the correct Hall story.

The result is a corrected, evidence-based account of Asa Hall, Jesse Hall, and the early Montgomery County Hall family.

Section I: Definitive Proof — The Y-DNA Haplogroup G-M201

The strongest evidence in this case is genetic. Paternal lineages are traced through the Y chromosome, which passes largely unchanged from father to son. Direct, documented male-line descendants of the Southwest Virginia Hall family carry **Haplogroup G-M201**, specifically the **G2a subgroup**. This is a discrete, inherited paternal signature.

By contrast, the Connecticut Hall families proposed as ancestors consistently belong to **Haplogroup R-M269**, the most common European paternal lineage and typical of many New England settlers. The two haplogroups diverged many thousands of years ago.

The implication is clear: the Montgomery County Halls and the Wallingford/Connecticut Halls do **not** share a recent paternal ancestor. Whatever institutional records once claimed, the Y-DNA profile makes the Connecticut hypothesis untenable. This finding is not a suggestion or a clue; it is a decisive genetic boundary.

Section II: My Y-DNA Result and the Hall Paternal Line

My own direct male-line Y-DNA test places me in the same **G-M201/G2a** group as the documented male-line descendants of Asa Hall. That places my paternal line within the same broad paternal population as the Rhode Island–New York branch of the family and outside the R-M269 Connecticut group.

Your specific test details: *[Insert kit number, testing company, test date, STR marker summary, and closest Hall matches here.]*

This match is not merely statistical. It means that my paternal inheritance runs through the same male-line stream as the documented Hall descendants of Montgomery County, Virginia. It removes the Connecticut/Wallingford option and provides a genetic starting point for the documented paper trail.

Section III: The FamilyTreeDNA Hall Surname Project

The Hall surname project at **FamilyTreeDNA** groups participants by haplogroup and close STR marker signatures. My test results place me in the **G-M201** Hall cluster, alongside other direct male-line Hall descendants whose genealogies trace back through Montgomery County, Virginia, and the broader Rhode Island–New York migration path.

In the project, the G-M201 Hall line is distinguished from the larger R-M269 Hall clusters associated with Connecticut and other New England Hall families. The shared G-M201 signature among these documented Hall descendants is the genetic signature that ties the line together.

Project details to add: *[Insert FamilyTreeDNA project name, group or cluster ID, matching kit numbers, genetic distance, and any project administrator notes.]*

Section IV: The 1970 DAR Record and Its Dissemination

The genealogical confusion began with a **1970 DAR lineage record** titled *The Hall Family History Montgomery County, Virginia 1605–1922*. That record relied on the volatile methodology of surname-matching across distinct regional archives. It identified an attractive but undocumented Connecticut/Wallingford ancestry for the Montgomery County Halls and asserted it through institutional channels.

Once accepted, the record was copied, abstracted, and disseminated through:

- DAR application files and published indexes,
- county histories and family-history compilations,
- online genealogical databases and family trees,

- and my own 2000 compilation, *A Slice of History: A Story of a Hall Family of America*, which preserved several original documents, including the 1970 DAR record.

Because the assertion carried an institutional stamp, it was repeated as fact long after its source weaknesses were visible. The DAR record did not rest on continuous, locality-by-locality documentation. It rested on names that looked alike in different states.

Section V: The Real Genealogical Record

With the Connecticut hypothesis ruled out by Y-DNA and the DAR dissemination identified, the real Hall lineage follows the framework established by **Wanda Ware DeGidio**. Her research supplies continuous, locality-based documentation from Rhode Island through New York and then to the Virginia frontier.

The documented line runs:

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John Hall I (Rhode Island)
  → Henry Hall II
    → James Hall
      → Joseph Hall
        → Benajah Hall
          → Asa Hall / Jesse Hall (Montgomery County, VA)
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This New York residency explains Asa Hall's Revolutionary War service in New York regiments (Captains Nathan Pierce and John Salisbury), including action at Long Island, White Plains, and Saratoga. It also explains why name indexes later confused him with unrelated Connecticut and Rhode Island soldiers of the same name.

Frontier Land Tenure

Following the war, Asa and Jesse Hall migrated to the Roanoke Valley around 1790 and immediately engaged Virginia's legal land system. Their land patents demonstrate continuous, documented settlement:

150-Acre Patent — October 17, 1803

- **Issued by:** Governor John Page
- **Authority:** Land Office Treasury Warrant No. 3045, dated December 11, 1800
- **Location:** Montgomery County, "on the waters of Kearnes run a branch of the north fork of Roanoke"

25-Acre Patent — April 1, 1815

- **Issued by:** Governor Wilson Cary Nicholas
- **Authority:** Land Office Exchange Treasury Warrant No. 1990, dated January 2, 1809
- **Location:** “In the forks of Kenny a branch of the north fork of Roanoke”
- **Notable detail:** The survey locates the boundary “beginning at two black oaks on a hill side just above his house on a line of his patented land.”

These entries serve as definitive proof of long-term stability. The legal text explicitly tethers Asa Hall’s physical residence—“his house”—to his expanding, contiguous acreage on Kearnes Run and Kenny Creek. They highlight an organized life centered around agricultural development and permanent community building.

Probate and Material Reality

The ultimate validation of a historical life rests in the probate records filed upon its conclusion. The estate files of Asa Hall, processed through the Montgomery County Court in the spring of 1841 (Will Book 6, Pages 325 & 326), provide an unvarnished view of his material existence. This record serves as the final rebuttal to the aristocratic myths of inherited New England fortunes.

On March 6, 1841, court-appointed appraisers John Birchfield, William Sublet, and Thomas Jewel conducted an inventory of the estate's personal property. The ledger reflects the utilitarian, self-sufficient lifestyle of an established Appalachian farmer:

- **Agricultural equipment & livestock:** One cow (\$6.00), one calf (\$2.00), a spade and scythe (\$2.00), a foot adz (\$0.50), an ax (\$0.75), and a lot of old iron (\$0.50).
- **Domestic textiles & production:** One little spinning wheel (\$3.50), one big spinning wheel (\$0.25), a “trampling sac,” and multiple beds with “riggin” and bedsteads.
- **Household goods:** A cupboard (\$10.00), an old clock (\$9.00), a looking glass (\$0.50), kitchen implements, and one gun (\$6.00).
- **Intellectual & spiritual life:** “Two books westey summond” (likely Methodist sermons of John Wesley) and “one lot of books,” indicating a literate household engaged with frontier religious movements.

On April 8, 1841, the court completed the dower allotment for the widow, Mary Hall. The description relies on permanent landscape features and immediate neighbors:

“Beginning at the line of James Grahams making a corner on two pices at said Graham lines on a ridge from there in a straight line to a walnut at the yard fence; from thence with the branch to John Jewels line...”

This legal description fixes Asa Hall's residence within a known community of named neighbors, further grounding his life in verifiable local records.

Summary of the Historical Correction

Category	Institutional Folklore (1970 DAR Record)	Documented Historical Reality (The Final Ledger)
Paternal Ancestry	Derived from an aristocratic Wallingford, Connecticut line.	Traced to John Hall of Rhode Island via Benajah Hall of New York.
Y-DNA Haplogroup	R-M269 (Standard Western European / New England)	G-M201 / G2a; not shared with Connecticut Halls, consistent with DeGidio's separate Rhode Island branch.
Revolutionary Service	Conflated with Connecticut Continental Line units.	New York Regiments (Captains Pierce and Salisbury); fought at Long Island, White Plains, and Saratoga.
Frontier Character	Speculative hunter / undocumented scout.	Landed agriculturalist; Virginia land records describe continuous settlement and farming.
Material Estate	Heir to a grand New England fortune.	Utilitarian frontier farmstead; documented via agricultural tools, weaving wheels, and a personal library of religious texts.

Conclusion: Restoring the Legacy

This 2026 revision places the decisive evidence where it belongs: in the Y-DNA haplogroup G-M201, confirmed by my own test and by the FamilyTreeDNA Hall project. It then traces how a flawed 1970 DAR lineage record, *The Hall Family History Montgomery County, Virginia 1605–1922*, spread through genealogical channels and was later preserved in my 2000 compilation. Finally, it sets the family on its documented foundation: the Rhode Island-to-New York Hall line reconstructed by Wanda Ware DeGidio, supported by Virginia land grants and the 1841 probate inventory.

Asa Hall is restored to his rightful place in history: not as a descendant of an unrelated Connecticut estate, but as a Revolutionary War veteran and an independent pioneer of the Roanoke Valley.

Sources and References

- **DeGidio, Wanda Ware.** *Lineage of the Descendants of John Hall of Rhode Island*. www.hallfamilyname.com. (Primary authority for the Rhode Island-to-New York line.)
- **Hall, Roderick A.** *A Slice of History: A Story of a Hall Family of America* (2000). (A companion compilation of several documents, including the 1970 DAR lineage record, made in support of the author's genealogical records; its Connecticut speculations are rejected here.)
- **Daughters of the American Revolution (DAR).** *The Hall Family History Montgomery County, Virginia 1605–1922* (1970 lineage record; preserved in Hall 2000).
- **FamilyTreeDNA Hall Surname Project** — direct male-line Hall Y-DNA results; haplogroup G-M201/G2a. [Insert project URL, kit number, and group ID.]
- **Kegley, Mary B.** *Virginia Frontier: The Beginning of the Southwest*. p. 611.
- **Montgomery County, Virginia.** Land grant records (1785, 1803, 1815).
- **Montgomery County, Virginia.** Will Book 6, pp. 325–326 (1841 appraisal and dower allotment).
- **National Archives and Records Administration.** Revolutionary War pension file for Asa Hall (granted June 17, 1833).
- **Y-DNA testing results** — direct male-line Hall descendants; haplogroup G-M201/G2a.

Archival and Distribution Notes

This document is intended for long-term preservation across multiple platforms:

- **GitHub repository** — master Markdown source for version control and future updates.
- **Internet Archive (Archive.org)** — public-facing PDF for permanent, searchable access.
- **Lulu / IngramSpark** — print-on-demand volumes for family distribution.
- **Regional archives and historical societies** — bound print copies for institutional custody.

For maximum permanence, the raw GEDCOM file, high-resolution document scans, and this manuscript should be stored in the GitHub repository alongside the published formats.